

# Clara Berestycki

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<https://claraberes.github.io/>

## EDUCATION

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- 2021– **Columbia University**, School of International and Public Affairs. *New York, USA*  
PhD candidate in Sustainable Development
- 2016–2020 **Ecole Normale Supérieure Paris-Saclay**, *Paris Area, France*  
Department of Social Sciences
- 2018–2020 **Ecole Polytechnique, ENSAE**, *Paris Area, France*  
Master in Economics
- 2016–2017 **Université Panthéon-Sorbonne, Université Paris-Sorbonne**, *Paris, France*  
Completion of three separate degrees: Bachelor of Science in Economics, Bachelor of Arts in Sociology, Bachelor of Arts in Philosophy
- 2014–2016 **Lycée Henri IV**, *Paris, France*  
B/L “preparatory class.” Two-year program aimed at preparing for national competitive entrance exams to French “Grandes Ecoles”

## REFERENCES

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### Keith Chen

Professor of Economics

UCLA Anderson School of Management

[keith.chen@anderson.ucla.edu](mailto:keith.chen@anderson.ucla.edu)

### Jonathan Dingel

Professor of Economics

Columbia University

[j.dingel@columbia.edu](mailto:j.dingel@columbia.edu)

### Robert Metcalfe

Professor of International and Public Affairs

Columbia University

[robert.metcalfe@columbia.edu](mailto:robert.metcalfe@columbia.edu)

### Jeffrey Shrader

Professor of International and Public Affairs

Columbia University

[jgs2103@columbia.edu](mailto:jgs2103@columbia.edu)

## WORKING PAPERS

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1. **Pricing wildfire smoke avoidance: activity reallocation in daily mobility** (*Job Market Paper, draft available upon request.*)

**Abstract:** This paper estimates the welfare cost of avoiding wildfire smoke during the 2018 California fire season. Using individual smartphone location data, I construct daily ZIP-to-ZIP origin–destination trip flows across activities, including outdoor recreation, work, and other indoor trips. I embed these flows in a logit model of activity participation and destination choice, in which smoke deters both leaving home and visiting polluted locations. The destination-choice margin is estimated as a gravity equation, extending the travel cost method to a setting with comprehensive spatial substitution across destinations. I find that outdoor trips fall by 25 % when destination smoke exceeds  $75 \mu\text{g m}^{-3}$  and by 17 % when origin smoke exceeds this threshold, while trips to work and other indoor activities respond less. The behavioral cost of the season is around \$500 million. I find that air quality alerts increase responses, and that costs rise by 20% under alert-level awareness of moderate smoke.

2. **Climate Policy Uncertainty and Firms’ and Investors’ Behavior**  
with Pier Basaglia, Stefano Carattini, Antoine Dechezleprêtre, and Tobias Kruse  
**Revisions requested, Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics.**

## PUBLICATIONS

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Behavioral responses to wildfire smoke: Insights from smartphone location data with Keith Chen (2026), *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 123 (18), e2527320123. Received “Best Student Paper Award” at the 2025 NAREA Conference.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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Short-term Labor Adaptation to Disasters (with Hannah Farkas)

## PRE-DOCTORAL WORK

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1. Measuring and assessing the effects of climate policy uncertainty (with Stefano Carattini, Antoine Dechezleprêtre, and Tobias Kruse). OECD Economics Department Working Papers, No. 1724, OECD Publishing, <https://doi.org/10.1787/34483d83-en>.
2. Assessing the efficiency of environmental policy design and evaluation: Results from a 2018 cross-country survey (with Antoine Dechezleprêtre). OECD Economics Department Working Papers, No. 1611, OECD Publishing, <https://doi.org/10.1787/482f8f8e-en>.

## RESEARCH POSITIONS

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|           |                                                                                 |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024–2026 | Research Assistant for Professor Suresh Naidu, Columbia University              |
| 2020–2022 | Research Assistant for Professor Wolfram Schlenker, Columbia University         |
| 2021      | Research Assistant for Professor Eugénie Dugoua and Professor Marion Dumas, LSE |
| 2019      | Research Intern for Antoine Dechezleprêtre, OECD Economics Directorate          |

## TEACHING

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*Teaching Assistant for all positions.*

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|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spring 2023, 24 | Microeconomics for Public Policy II, MPA, Columbia University                           |
| Fall 2023       | Research Methods and Quantitative Techniques in Policy Making, MPA, Columbia University |
| Fall 2022       | Microeconomics, MPA, Columbia University                                                |

## SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

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|      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 | Camp Resources, Occasional Workshop in Environment and Resource Economics@UCSB (scheduled), 3rd Early Career Workshop on Applied Environmental & Climate Change Economics (scheduled)                                                                     |
| 2025 | Stanford Global Environment Policy Student Seminar, TWEEDS, NAREA, AERE@Western Economic Association, Occasional Workshop in Environment and Resource Economics@UCSB, Interdisciplinary PhD Workshop in Sustainable Development at Columbia (IPWSD)       |
| 2024 | Paris Saclay Applied Economics Seminar                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 2023 | IPWSD, CIRED PhD Student Seminar                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 2022 | Federal Reserve Bank of New York and Columbia University Center for Environmental Economics and Policy (CEEP) Conference on Environmental Economics and Policy, IPWSD, Bank of France Climate Research Seminar (Banque de France Réseau Recherche Climat) |

## HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS AND FELLOWSHIPS

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|           |                                                                       |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024, 25  | Columbia Center for Political Economy Graduate Student Grant          |
| 2024      | Columbia Center for Environmental Economics and Policy Research Grant |
| 2016–2021 | French Education Dept. Merit-Based Scholarship                        |

## OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

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|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2019–2020 | <b>OECD Environment Directorate</b> , Part-time Consultant. <i>Paris, France</i><br>Assessment of the stringency of environmental policies in the water and waste sectors. |
| 2017      | <b>TotalEnergies</b> , Renewable Energy Division, Strategy Analyst Intern. <i>Paris, France</i>                                                                            |

## SERVICE

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| Referee: | Journal of Environmental Economics and Management, Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, Climate Policy, International Forecasting |
| 2024     | Columbia Sustainable Development Doctoral Society, President                                                                                                      |
| 2022, 23 | Organizer of the Columbia Alliance Summer School in Paris (Budget: \$20K)                                                                                         |
| 2022-25  | Mentor with Article 1, French NGO to promote equal opportunities in higher education                                                                              |

## LANGUAGES

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| French  | Native                        |
| English | Full professional proficiency |
| Italian | Conversational                |